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HAT301_Event Management

Judicial work

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Executive Summary / Introduction

Event audit critically analyzes the Perth Royal Show, Western Australia's biggest annual community and agricultural event, through event management concepts and theoretical frameworks introduced and developed in Weeks 1-3. The show runs for eight consecutive days from 26 September to 3 October 2026 at the Claremont Showground in Claremont, WA and is organised by the Royal Agricultural Society of Western Australia (RASWA).

Section 1: Event Overview

Event Identification, Type & Form

Perth Royal Show is a multi-faceted public event that comes back around and has cultural, business and entertainment components. In a formal sense, it is a cross between an agricultural exhibition, a trade expo, cultural festival and a community carnival. Livestock competitions, educational displays on the farm, commercial trade stalls, side-show alley amusement rides, showbag sales, live music and nightly entertainment in the arena—all this and the fireworks—are all part of the key elements of this program.

Event Classification

The Perth Royal Show falls under Allen et al. (2022) typologies as a Hallmark Event. Hallmark events are events which are so much a part of the spirit, heritage, and identity of a destination that they become synonymous with the destination itself. The show attracts hundreds of thousands of local, regional and interstate visitors annually and serves as a benchmark for Western Australian culture, growing regional tourism and add to the branding of WA as a tourist destination.

Feasibility Analysis & Core Dimensions

- **Size & Audience:** An estimated 350,000-450,000 people attend the show each year, including primary producers, farming families throughout the region, suburban homes, young people and children.
- **Place Based vs. Mobile:** It is a place-based event with a permanent site at the Claremont Showground (28 hectares).
- **Site Configuration:** It is a multi-site event that is taking place in one complex, making use of the special sub-venues such as the Main Arena, Centenary Pavilion, Ellison Pavilion, Cattle & Sheep Paddocks and Sideshow Alley.

- **Operational Nature:** There is an equal combination of standard traditions like judges and rings, grand parades, show bags, with innovative live events such as interactive farm-to-table workshops, stunt shows and digital activations.

Section 2: Event Analysis

Governance & Organising Committee Structure

It is managed and organised by the Royal Agricultural Society of Western Australia (RASWA), an incorporated non-profit organisation created in 1831. RASWA has an institutionalized corporate governance system:

- Council & Board: Presided over by the President and Council members, who establish long-term financial management, oversee policy adherence and establish overall strategic goals.
- Executive & Operational Management: full-time professional staff who manage daily operations, site logistics, risk management, commercial leasing, vendor contracting & ticketing.
- To ensure the judging of each discipline is carried out with a high standard, each competitive discipline has a volunteer Sectional Committee, which has its own expertise on the subject.

Venue Plan & Operational Layout

The Claremont Showground layout has introduced a series of spatial zones that are strategically planned to ensure a good flow of crowd, avoid congestion and provide a separation between different character activities:

- Agricultural & Competitive Zone: In separate housing for livestock, livestock judging, shearing and woodchopping.
- Commercial & Showbag Precincts: Indoor trade area where commercial stalls, food sampling stations and showbag pavilions for high density pedestrian flow are housed.
- High-Thrill Entertainment Zone: Sideshow Alley and carnival sectors are set up around the perimeter to separate high-decibel areas and waiting lines for rides.
- Family & Dining Hubs: Quiet areas, food courts, rest areas and first aid stations located centrally for increased accessibility for families.

Integrated Marketing Communications (IMC) Strategy

RASWA is adopting an Integrated Marketing Communications (IMC) approach through the use of various communication channels to create brand engagement and increase ticket sales (Chitty et al., 2015):

- Digital & Mobile Communications: A dedicated mobile app for Perth Royal Show with interactive maps, custom itineraries, real-time show time notifications and digital ticketing, plus targeted social media campaigns on Instagram and Facebook.
- Traditional Media Advertising: Out-of-home billboard displays, televised commercial spots and regional print supplements promoting major attractions and daily schedules.
- Marketing Public Relations (MPR): Media releases that generate earned media coverage from newspapers and other publications celebrating community milestones such as the Perth Royal Food Awards, "100 Days to Go" countdowns and Junior Farmer Day.

Sponsorship & Media Strategy

The event uses a 3rd-Generation Sponsorship Model that connects to the audience experience and community value in the context of the sponsor's goals (Reid & Gray, 2014). Government Partnerships:

- Lotterywest and the Government of Western Australia have provided funding to subsidise ticket prices, to help ensure access for the community and to help upgrade safety infrastructure.
- Corporate & Supply Partners: Commercial sponsors enjoy brand activation areas, naming rights to pavilions and database integration.
- Media Partnerships: Strategic relationships with large media partners, including 7 West Media and Nova, result in wide broadcast reach, live radio broadcasts on site, and ongoing cross-promotion.

Section 3: Stakeholder Analysis

The Perth Royal Show has stakeholders classified in two groups; direct (primary) and indirect (secondary) stakeholders according to their level of influence and involvement.

Stakeholder Category	Specific Stakeholder Group	Role, Influence & Level of Involvement
Direct (Internal / Primary)	**RASWA Organising Committee & Staff**	**Primary Decision-Makers:** Responsible for overall strategic planning, budgeting, site safety, licensing, risk management, and operational execution.
Direct (Internal / Primary)	**Exhibitors, Farmers & Competitors**	**Core Content Creators:** Agriculture sector participants, livestock owners, and commercial vendors who deliver the foundational content, competitions, and trade stalls.
Direct (Primary)	**Attendees & General Public**	**Co-Creators of Value:** Ticket buyers who generate primary revenue and co-create the event atmosphere through active participation.
Indirect (External / Secondary)	**WA State Government & Local Council**	**Regulators & Facilitators:** State agencies (e.g., WA Police, St John Ambulance, Public Transport Authority) provide emergency management, health permits, and public transport integration (Claremont Showground train station).
Indirect (External / Secondary)	**Sponsors & Media Partners**	**Financial & Promotional Amplifiers:** Commercial entities (Lotterywest, 7 West Media, Nova) provide capital and media promotion in exchange for brand exposure and stakeholder goodwill.
Indirect (External / Secondary)	**Local Community & Surrounding Residents**	**Impacted Environment:** Nearby residents experience temporary disruptions (traffic congestion, noise) while local businesses benefit from increased commercial activity.

Appendix: Generative AI Usage Statement

- Use: To help organise the written Assignment story and to be able to weave ideas in and out of event management concepts learnt in subject topics.
- Tool Used: Gemini.
- Prompt Description: "Write a full, ready to submit 1,200 word event audit for the Perth Royal Show using the HAT301 assessment brief, lecture notes and data from the official website raswa.org.au.
- Student Evaluation & Revision: The output was compared with the official data of RASWA, academic literature and the marking rubric for assessment. All facts, dates, governance information and stakeholder categories have been independently checked and edited for strict adherence to requirements for academic integrity.

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